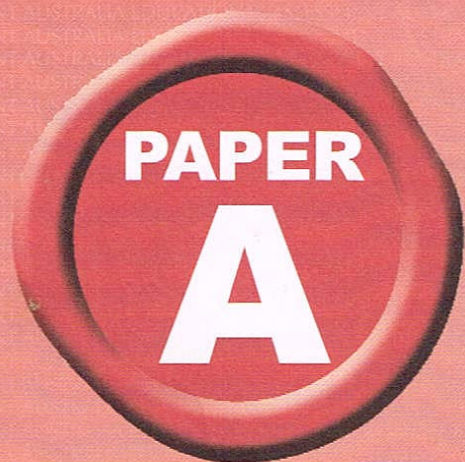




ICAS

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS AND
ASSESSMENTS FOR SCHOOLS

ENGLISH

2008

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

**PLEASE SEE BACK COVER FOR A LIST
OF THE YEAR LEVELS THAT SHOULD
SIT THIS PAPER**

AMY'S DRAGON

Amy's special friend was called Drogon. He was *nearly* a dragon but not quite. He was too small for a real dragon and he could not fly.

Drogon went to school with Amy whenever she was sad. He hopped up onto the roof of the car and puffed smoke at people on the pavements. This always made Amy laugh.

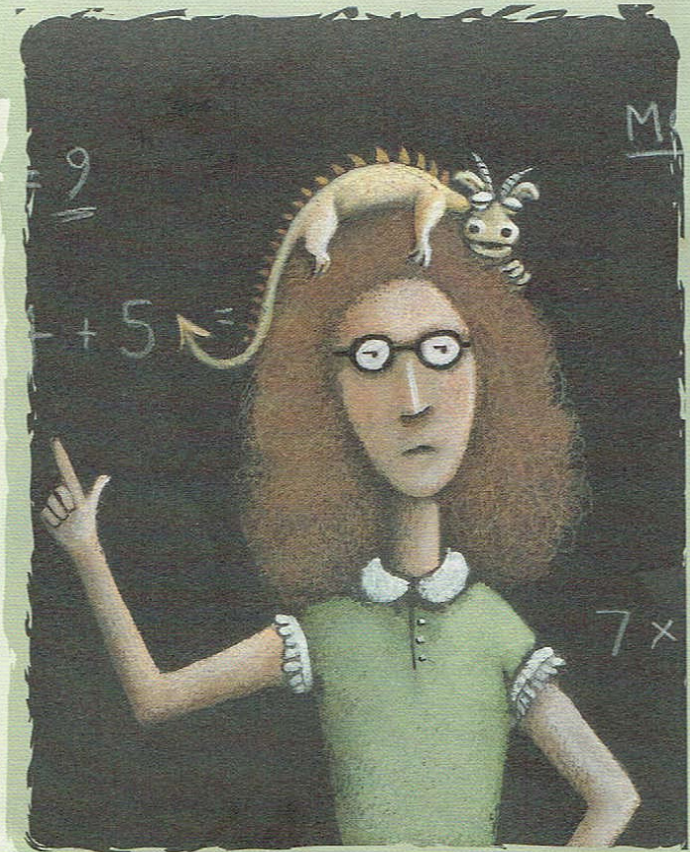
At school, no one else could see Drogon. Everybody said that he was Amy's imaginary friend.

'He is not!' said Amy. 'He's real.' Nobody believed her.

Drogon's favourite trick was sitting on the teacher's head. Mrs Flanders had beautiful curly red hair. It was perfect for nesting in. Drogon curled up in it and fell asleep.

Amy told all her friends about Drogon. She pointed at him. His tail was dangling in front of the teacher's nose.

'You're being silly,' said James. 'You're making it up.'

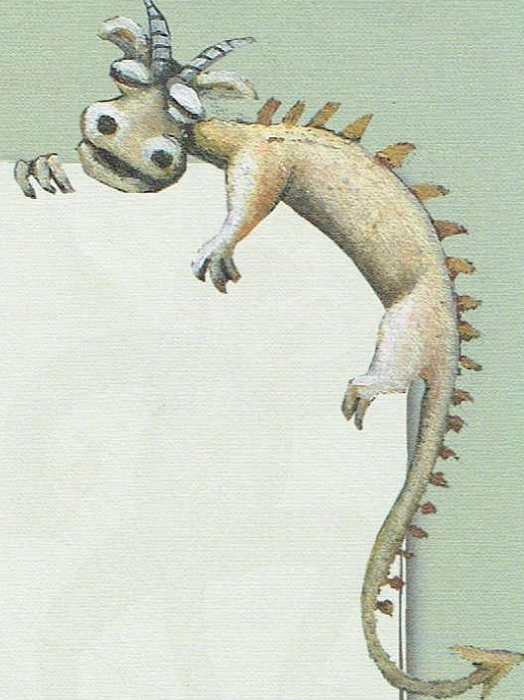


'No, I'm not!' said Amy crossly. 'I'm telling the truth and I shall prove it.'

Drogon opened a sleepy eye. His tail twitched. It tickled the teacher's nose and made her sneeze.

'There!' shouted Amy. 'He just made Mrs Flanders sneeze!'

'No, he didn't,' said James. 'Everybody knows that she has got a cold.'



1. In what way was Drogon different from a dragon?
 - (A) He stood on cars.
 - (B) He had no friends.
 - (C) He had a nickname.
 - (D) He was not able to fly.

2. When did Drogon go to school with Amy?
 - (A) when Amy was unhappy
 - (B) when Mrs Flanders was teaching
 - (C) when Drogon wanted to play tricks
 - (D) when Amy's mother drove them to school

3. When Drogon blew smoke at people walking on the pavements, Amy would
 - (A) laugh.
 - (B) blow smoke too.
 - (C) tell Drogon to behave.
 - (D) tell the people about Drogon.

4. In the text the word 'You're' can be replaced by
 - (A) Your.
 - (B) You are.
 - (C) You were.
 - (D) You there.

5. Which word in the text tells the reader that only Amy saw Drogon?
 - (A) 'imaginary'
 - (B) 'believed'
 - (C) 'silly'
 - (D) 'prove'

6. Which line from the text matches the picture?
 - (A) 'He was *nearly* a dragon but not quite'
 - (B) 'He hopped up onto the roof of the car'
 - (C) 'Drogon's favourite trick was sitting on the teacher's head'
 - (D) 'His tail was dangling in front of the teacher's nose'

Monkey Chain!

Make a string of swinging monkeys to hang out in your room. They're heaps of fun!

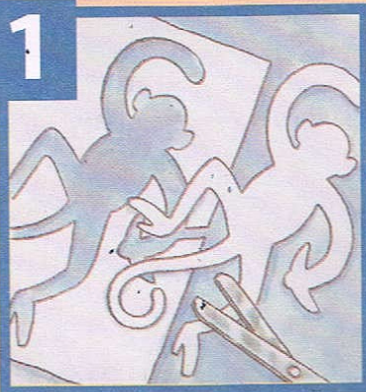
What you need:

- Pencil
- Sheet of cardboard
- Scissors
- Sheets of different coloured paper
- Paintbrush
- Poster paints in different colours

OOPS!

Cutting around the monkeys' tails is a bit fiddly. Use nail scissors to make it easier.

Trace or copy this monkey for your own monkey template.



Trace or copy the monkey outline onto the cardboard, then cut it out.



Use this monkey as a template. Draw around it on different coloured sheets of paper.

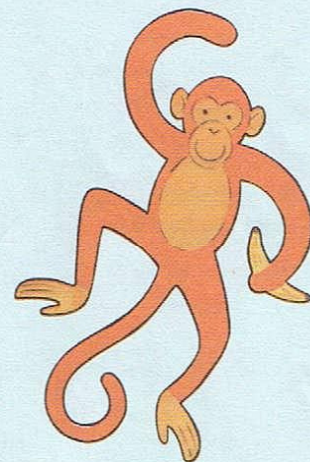


Cut out your monkeys. Paint faces and bodies on both sides of the paper. (Don't forget the bananas!)



Hook the monkeys together by their arms or tails. Then hang them up in your room!

7. According to the information, how are the monkeys joined together?
- (A) with string
 - (B) by their tails or arms
 - (C) by their feet
 - (D) with hooks or a chain
8. The word 'OOPS!' could best be replaced with
- (A) BE CAREFUL!
 - (B) DON'T WORRY!
 - (C) NEXT!
 - (D) WOW!
9. Why is this monkey included in the information?
- (A) to help you decide where to hang the monkeys
 - (B) to show you how many monkeys to make
 - (C) to give you a pattern for making the monkeys
 - (D) to show that cutting out the monkeys can be tricky
10. In which step do you first use coloured paper?
- (A) Step 1
 - (B) Step 2
 - (C) Step 3
 - (D) Step 4
11. The instructions suggest that you use nail scissors to cut around the monkeys' tails because nail scissors are
- (A) safe.
 - (B) silver.
 - (C) small.
 - (D) straight.
12. In Step 3 the words 'Don't forget the bananas!' are placed in brackets () in order to
- (A) make a joke of the instruction.
 - (B) include more information about colours.
 - (C) tell you to complete the instruction quickly.
 - (D) show that the instruction is less important.



Read *Muttaborrasaurus* and answer questions 13 to 18.

MUTTABURRA

Quick! Hide!

Why?

Because a Muttaborra saw us.

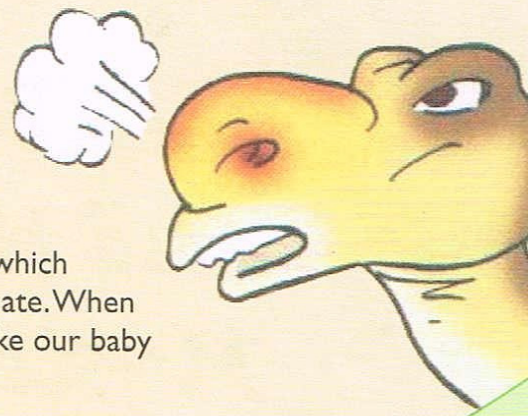
IT'S A WHAT?

A *Muttaborrasaurus* was discovered by farmer Doug Langdon on his property near the town of Muttaborra in Queensland. *Muttaborrasaurus* lived 100 million years ago, but Doug only found the dinosaur in 1963. By that time, the *Muttaborrasaurus*' bones had become fossilised—buried in sediments and turned to stone.

UTTABURRASAUROS

LOOK OUT BELLOW!

Muttaborrasaurus' skull shows a large, upwards-bulging muzzle that may have had a flap of skin over it. This could have been inflated for display, or to produce a blaring sound to scare off predators or call to other *Muttaborrasaurus*.

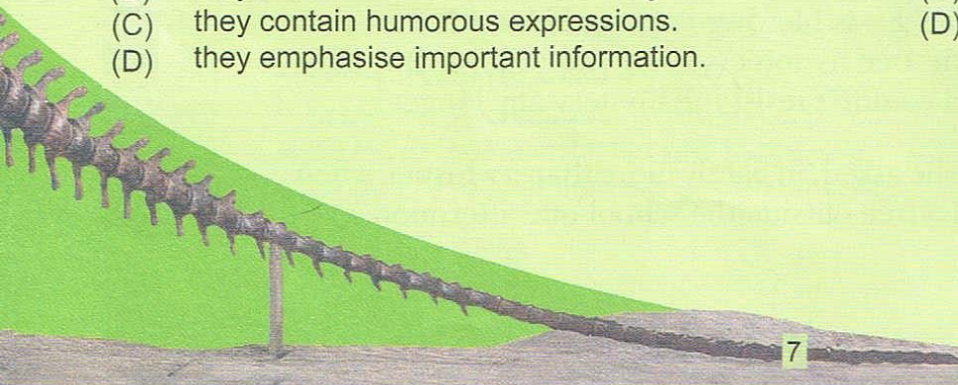


NEED A DENTIST?

Tough teeth! *Muttaborrasaurus* had teeth that worked like a pair of shears, which could have been used to snap off the leaves of tough plants (cycads) that it ate. When its teeth fell out they were replaced all at once rather than one at a time like our baby teeth are.

To go with its tough teeth, *Muttaborrasaurus* had unusually strong jaws. *Muttaborrasaurus* could have chomped its teeth to scare off predators or other *Muttaborrasaurus*.

13. Why was the dinosaur called *Muttaborrasaurus*?
- (A) It was named after the town of Muttaborra.
 - (B) *Muttaborrasaurus* was where it was found.
 - (C) The name sounded like 'Muttaborra saw us.'
 - (D) All the other names for dinosaurs had been used.
14. The writer says 'It's a what?' because the *Muttaborrasaurus*
- (A) is extremely frightening.
 - (B) is an uncommon dinosaur.
 - (C) cannot be seen by humans.
 - (D) cannot see into the distance.
15. The writer uses the word 'only' to emphasise
- (A) how old the *Muttaborrasaurus* was.
 - (B) how long the *Muttaborrasaurus* could live for.
 - (C) how long Doug took to find the *Muttaborrasaurus*.
 - (D) how recently the *Muttaborrasaurus* was discovered.
16. When a word sounds like the thing it is describing, it is called onomatopoeia. Which word is an example of onomatopoeia?
- (A) 'muzzle'
 - (B) 'teeth'
 - (C) 'chomped'
 - (D) 'scare'
17. Some words in the text are written in CAPITAL letters because
- (A) they are sub-headings.
 - (B) they make the text look less boring.
 - (C) they contain humorous expressions.
 - (D) they emphasise important information.
18. What is the main purpose of this text?
- (A) to explain
 - (B) to describe
 - (C) to tell a story
 - (D) to give an opinion



Meg Banana and the Mysterious Umbrella

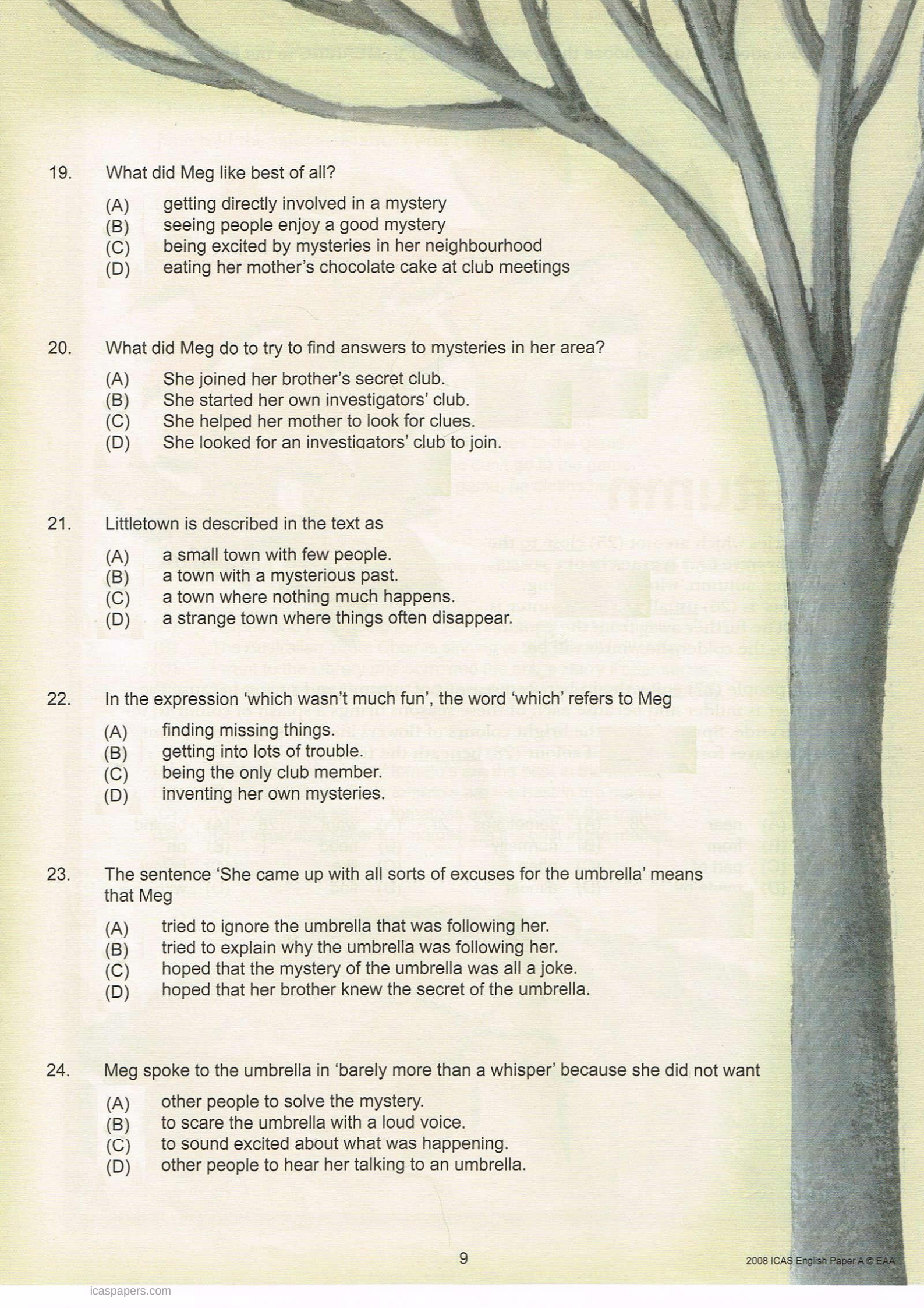


Meg Banana loved a good mystery. She didn't think there was anything more exciting than being at the centre of a truly puzzling or inexplicable event.

To solve all the mysteries in her neighbourhood Meg founded the Littletown Secret Investigators Club. She was President. She was also the only member. Meg didn't count her brother, Brian, because he only came to club meetings to eat the chocolate cake her mother baked each week. He wasn't serious about solving mysteries. But then neither was anyone else. You see, nothing ever happened in Littletown. It was so completely devoid of mystery that Meg often had to invent one herself, which wasn't much fun and got her into lots of trouble. Whenever anything went missing in Littletown, people came to Meg's house first. And they weren't interested in her clues or riddles because they didn't believe there was a mystery to solve.

Which is why they wouldn't believe her now if she told them about the black umbrella that followed her to school by day, then hung in the trees outside her bedroom at night, moaning. And why should they? Meg didn't believe it, at first. She came up with all sorts of excuses for the umbrella, like the wind was blowing it along behind her or that Brian had hung it in the tree as some sort of stupid joke. But after three days, Meg Banana couldn't resist the mystery any longer.

'Are you following me?' she asked, in barely more than a whisper, when she found it hanging in a tree outside the school one afternoon.

- 
19. What did Meg like best of all?
- (A) getting directly involved in a mystery
 - (B) seeing people enjoy a good mystery
 - (C) being excited by mysteries in her neighbourhood
 - (D) eating her mother's chocolate cake at club meetings
20. What did Meg do to try to find answers to mysteries in her area?
- (A) She joined her brother's secret club.
 - (B) She started her own investigators' club.
 - (C) She helped her mother to look for clues.
 - (D) She looked for an investigators' club to join.
21. Littleton is described in the text as
- (A) a small town with few people.
 - (B) a town with a mysterious past.
 - (C) a town where nothing much happens.
 - (D) a strange town where things often disappear.
22. In the expression 'which wasn't much fun', the word 'which' refers to Meg
- (A) finding missing things.
 - (B) getting into lots of trouble.
 - (C) being the only club member.
 - (D) inventing her own mysteries.
23. The sentence 'She came up with all sorts of excuses for the umbrella' means that Meg
- (A) tried to ignore the umbrella that was following her.
 - (B) tried to explain why the umbrella was following her.
 - (C) hoped that the mystery of the umbrella was all a joke.
 - (D) hoped that her brother knew the secret of the umbrella.
24. Meg spoke to the umbrella in 'barely more than a whisper' because she did not want
- (A) other people to solve the mystery.
 - (B) to scare the umbrella with a loud voice.
 - (C) to sound excited about what was happening.
 - (D) other people to hear her talking to an umbrella.

For questions 25 to 28 choose the words CLOSEST IN MEANING to the underlined words.



Autumn

Countries which are not (25) close to the equator have four seasons in one year: summer, autumn, winter and spring. Summer is (26) usually hot and winter is cold. The further away from the equator you go, the colder the winter will be.

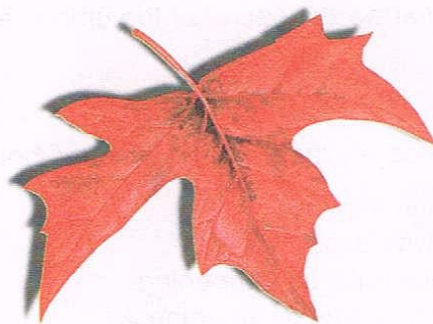
Most people (27) enjoy the in-between seasons of autumn and spring because the weather is milder and because each of these seasons brings a splash of colour to the countryside. Spring brings the bright colours of flowers and blossoms. In Autumn fallen leaves form a carpet of colour (28) beneath the trees.

25. (A) near
(B) from
(C) part of
(D) made by

26. (A) sometimes
(B) normally
(C) often
(D) almost

27. (A) want
(B) need
(C) like
(D) find

28. (A) behind
(B) on
(C) below
(D) with



For questions 29 and 30 choose the correct option.

29. Choose the option which correctly completes the sentence.

Jane told the sales assistant, 'I won't buy this pair of shoes because _____.'

- (A) it felt very tight
- (B) it feels very tight
- (C) they felt very tight
- (D) they feel very tight

30. Choose the sentence which has the same meaning.

John can only go to the game if he cleans his room.

- (A) John goes to the game and also cleans his room.
- (B) John has to clean his room until he goes to the game.
- (C) Unless John cleans his room, he can't go to the game.
- (D) Whenever John can't go to the game, he cleans his room.

For questions 31 and 32 choose the sentence which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

31. (A) Ahmed and I are going to our Aunt's Birthday party tonight.
(B) The Australian Youth Choir is singing at the school hall today.
(C) I went to the Library and borrowed the entire Harry Potter series.
(D) There will be an Organic food Fair at the local school on Saturday.

32. (A) That vegetable sellers' tomato's are the best in the market.
(B) That vegetable seller's tomato's are the best in the market.
(C) That vegetable sellers' tomatoes are the best in the market.
(D) That vegetable seller's tomatoes are the best in the market.



Head in the Clouds

Your head's in the clouds, my teacher said.
And I thought, how could that be?
If my head is in the clouds,
then where's the rest of me?

My feet are firmly on the ground,
as quite clearly can be seen,
so from my knees right to my neck
must be somewhere in between.

But between the clouds and ground
is such a terribly long way—
How could I ever stretch that far
even in a thousand days?

So either I must be a giant
to be that terribly tall
or my teacher needs new glasses—
she can hardly see at all!

John Malone

33. In the first line, what comment is the teacher making about the student?
- (A) The student has a bad cold.
 - (B) The student is daydreaming.
 - (C) The student is extremely tall.
 - (D) The student likes aeroplanes.
34. When the student thinks, 'how could that be?', he is probably feeling
- (A) quite delighted.
 - (B) a little annoyed.
 - (C) somewhat afraid.
 - (D) a sense of wonder.
35. The student believes that his head cannot be in the clouds because
- (A) he is not tall enough.
 - (B) he can see his head.
 - (C) he can hear his teacher talking.
 - (D) he does not have bad eyesight.
36. Why does the poet use so many questions in the poem?
- (A) to encourage the reader to think carefully
 - (B) because the poet is unsure of the answers
 - (C) to indicate that the student is being quite cheeky
 - (D) because the poet wants the reader to keep guessing
37. Alliteration is the repetition of the same sounds at the beginning of words. Which of these lines from the poem uses alliteration?
- (A) 'then where's the rest of me?'
 - (B) 'as quite clearly can be seen'
 - (C) 'even in a thousand days'
 - (D) 'to be that terribly tall'
38. What is the tone of the poem?
- (A) joyful
 - (B) playful
 - (C) sneaky
 - (D) impatient

BOOK REVIEWS

Lulubelle and her Bones Vashti Farrer With illustrations by David Cox

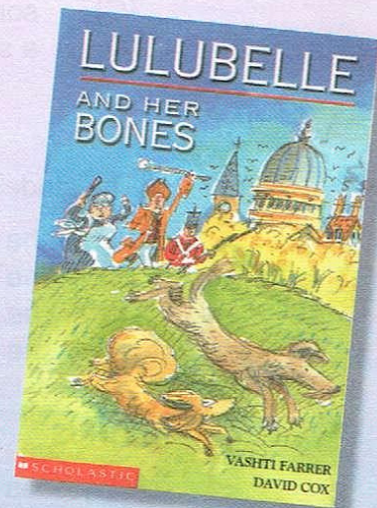
It's not only humans who long for freedom, excitement, love and adventure. Dogs do too. This is a delightful, thoroughly enjoyable tale for younger readers about two dogs, their bid for freedom and the outcome of their decisions. Lulubelle is a pampered lapdog, treated like a spoilt child rather than an animal by her rich, noble owner. One day she secretly wanders into another part of the mansion and discovers love with a lower class dog.

Together they escape the confines of their home and set out to reach London and a free life together. They experience great hardship, hunger and abuse. It's harder on Lulubelle, who is used to having every wish fulfilled. She realises that survival depends on adjusting to her new status, accepting and living with the choices she has made.

But their adventures are not all bad. They make some good friends along the way and learn many survival skills. Happy to simply be together, their compromises finally pay off. Their luck changes for the better and a new world is opened up to them with a bright, secure future.

This is an adventure story full of optimism, acceptance and hope.

★★★ Scholastic \$12.95 Age guide 7+



39. Where did Lulubelle live before she ran away?
- (A) a big castle in the city of London
 - (B) a green park in the middle of a city
 - (C) an enormous kennel outside an old house
 - (D) a large and expensive house outside London
40. The word 'confines', as it is used in the text, means
- (A) limits.
 - (B) wealth.
 - (C) sadness.
 - (D) activities.
41. Lulubelle found it hard to adjust to life outside her home because
- (A) she missed her owner very much.
 - (B) she had never been outside before.
 - (C) she was not used to having so much freedom.
 - (D) she was used to getting everything she wanted.
42. Which of the following statements about *Lulubelle and her Bones* is correct?
- (A) Lulubelle's adventures are very amusing.
 - (B) Lulubelle is the evil character in the story.
 - (C) The characters eventually find a better life.
 - (D) The characters find life in the city to be easy.

The World According to Warren

As told to Craig Silvey

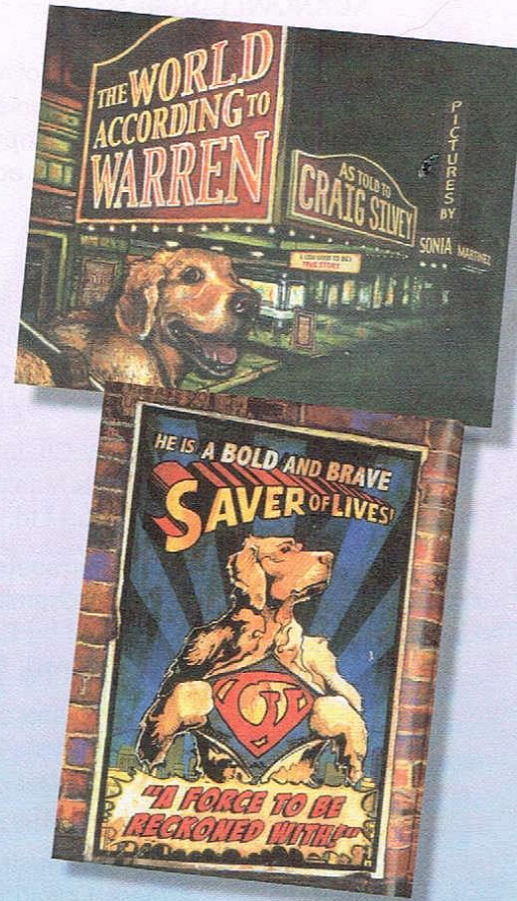
Pictures by Sonia Martinez

When Warren was training to be a guide dog he was very easily distracted. Just like any other over-energetic puppy, he loved to lick, sniff and chase everything. But the day he is introduced to Eleanor Rigby his life changes forever. He becomes her best friend, guiding her and guarding her even while she sleeps.

Warren has his pet hates like children and seagulls but his lifelong gripe is his name. Why can't he be called something more grand, like Boris or Conrad? After all, in his opinion, he is the bravest and boldest guide dog and an inspiration to everybody!

This story is, as the cover says, a mixture of comedy, drama and romance and Warren is witness to it all. It's a poignant story, more suited to the older child who can decipher what is being said in the pictures as well as the text. It's a thought-provoking book which could lead to worthwhile discussions.

★★★ Fremantle Press \$26.95 Age guide 10+



43. What role does Craig Silvey have in the book *The World According to Warren*?
- (A) He is the writer.
 - (B) He is the editor.
 - (C) He is a character.
 - (D) He is the narrator.
44. The second paragraph of the review of *The World According to Warren* gives some information about Warren. What do we know about Warren from this information?
- (A) He wants to keep improving himself.
 - (B) He thinks he has a very important name.
 - (C) He has an extremely high opinion of himself.
 - (D) He has become famous for being a guide dog.
45. What is common to *Lulubelle and her Bones* and *The World According to Warren*?
- (A) They are published by the same company.
 - (B) There are illustrations which accompany the stories.
 - (C) They are meant for readers who are seven years old.
 - (D) The main character is a dog which has run away from home.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

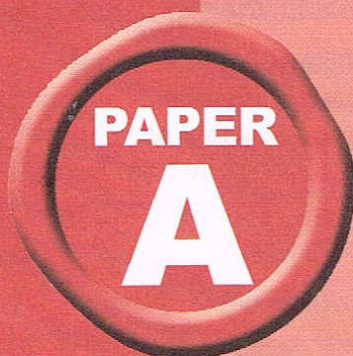
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- Pages 14–15** “Book Reviews” text from a review by Anastasia Gonis of *Lulubelle and her Bones* by Vashti Farrer with illustrations by David Cox, published in *Good Reading Magazine* March 2005 and a review by Merle Morcom of *The World According to Warren* by Craig Silvey with pictures by Sonia Martinez (Freemantle Press 2007) published in *Good Reading Magazine* November 2007. Copyright © Good Reading Magazine Pty Ltd. Book cover image of *Lulubelle and her Bones* used by permission of David Cox. Book cover image of *The World According to Warren* used by permission of Fremantle Press.

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AUSTRALIA: Year 3
BRUNEI: Primary 3
INDONESIA: Year 4
MALAYSIA: Standard 3
NEW ZEALAND: Year 4
PACIFIC: Year 3
SINGAPORE: Primary 2
SOUTH AFRICA: Grade 3





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2008 ICAS English Answer Keys

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	D	C	D	B	C	All Correct	C	B
2	A	A	A	A	D	D	B	B
3	A	B	B	B	C	A	C	A
4	B	A	C	C	B	D	B	C
5	A	C	D	B	A	C	D	A
6	C	D	C	D	B	A	C	D
7	B	A	B	A	B	A	B	B
8	A	D	A	C	B	C	D	A
9	C	B	B	D	C	D	D	C
10	B	D	D	D	C	B	A	B
11	C	C	D	C	D	A	D	D
12	D	D	C	D	A	B	C	C
13	A	A	C	A	B	A	D	D
14	B	A	D	D	B	B	C	D
15	D	B	C	A	B	C	D	B*
16	C	C	B	D	D	C	C	D
17	A	D	A	A	C	D	C	A
18	B	B	C	C	A	D	A	B
19	A	D	D	B	A	B	D	A
20	B	D	B	C	A	C	B	D
21	C	C	A	A	C	D	B	A
22	D	B	A	A	C	A	D	D
23	B	D	B	A	D	C	B	C
24	D	B	D	B	C	D	A	B
25	A	C	C	B	D	A	A	C
26	B	D	C	B	D	B	C	C
27	C	B	B	D	A	D	D	D
28	C	A	A	C	A	B	A	D
29	C or D	B	D	A	D	C	B	D
30	C	D	B	C	C	C	B	B
31	B	D	D	B	B	D	A	C
32	D	C	C	B	C	B	B	C
33	B	D	B	C	B	C	A	A
34	D	B	D	D	D	B	A	A
35	A	A	A	D	C	A	D	D

(Please turn over)



Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
36	C	B	D	C	B	B	A	A
37	D	A	A	A	A	B	C	A
38	B	C	C	D	A	B	B	A
39	D	A	B	A	A	D	B	C
40	A	C	C	B	C	B	D	D
41	D	B	A	D	D	A	A	B
42	C	C	A	C	B	A	B	C
43	A	A	A	D	A	C	A	B
44	C	A	B	A	D	B	C	A
45	B	B	C	B	B	C	B	C
46			B	B	A	D	A	D
47			C	C	D	C	C	C
48			D	A	D	D	A	A
49			D	C	D	C	C	A
50			A	B	B	A	D	C
51					A	A	C	B
52					D	A	A	D
53					A	C	A	C
54					B	B	C	B
55					C	C	A	B
56							D	A
57							D	B
58							D	D
59							C	B
60							C	A

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